

There's another use for the type of action carried out in a logic bomb "explosion" – to make restricted software trials. The embedded piece of code destroys the software after a defined period of time or renders it unusable until the user pays for its further use. Although this piece of code uses the same technique as a logic bomb, it has a non-destructive, non-malicious and user-transparent use, and is not typically referred to as one.

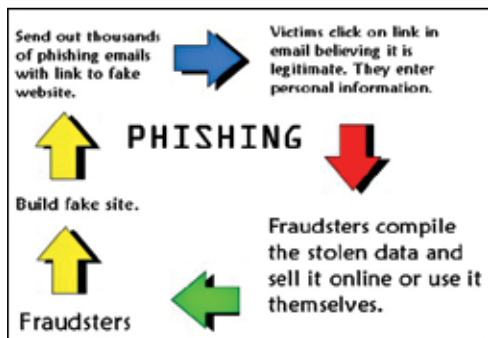
4. Denial-of-Service attack

A Denial-of-Service (DoS) attack is an explicit attempt by attackers to deny service to intended users of that service. It involves flooding a computer resource with more requests than it can handle consuming its available bandwidth which results in server overload. This causes the resource (e.g. a web server) to crash or slow down significantly so that no one can access it. Using this technique, the attacker can render a web site inoperable by sending massive amounts of traffic to the targeted site. A site may temporarily malfunction or crash completely, in any case resulting in inability of the system to communicate adequately. DoS attacks violate the acceptable use policies of virtually all internet service providers.

Another variation to a denial-of-service attack is known as a "Distributed Denial of Service" (DDoS) attack wherein a number of geographically widespread perpetrators flood the network traffic. Denial-of-Service attacks typically target high profile web site servers belonging to banks and credit card payment gateways. Web sites of companies such as Amazon, CNN, Yahoo, Twitter and eBay! are not spared either.

5. Phishing

This a technique of extracting confidential information such as credit card numbers and username-password combos by masquerading as a legitimate enterprise. Phishing is typically carried out by email spoofing. You've probably



How phishing can net some really interesting catches